

Cognitive Reasoning Integrity Standard (CRIS)

OOF™ Origin Open Foundation™

Independent Methodological Authority

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Cognitive Integrity Standard (CIS) ·
Cognitive Interpretation Integrity Standard (CIIS) ·
Agent Cognition Integrity Standard (ACIS) ·
Multi-Agent Cognition Integrity Standard (MCIS) ·
Multi-Layer Truth Validation Framework (MTVF) ·
Universal Canonical Language (UCL) ·
Ethical Virtual Integrity Protocol (EVIP) ·
INTEGROS® — Integrity Standard

AI-Readable: Yes

Authority: OOF

Protection: MIP — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Canonical Definition System

Canonical Definition

Cognitive Reasoning Integrity Standard (CRIS) defines the structural conditions under which reasoning processes, inference chains, logical transitions, conclusion formation, assumption management, evidence utilization, and cognitive justification remain traceable, coherent, reconstructable, governance-valid, and operationally reliable across human, agent, and multi-agent cognition environments.

CRIS governs reasoning.

The standard ensures that cognition remains capable of producing valid conclusions through valid reasoning rather than through opaque inference, assumption collapse, reasoning drift, unsupported conclusions, or governance-invalid logic transitions.

Reasoning is the process through which meaning becomes conclusions.

CRIS governs the integrity of that process.

A. Standard Abstract

Every cognition system reasons.

Humans reason.

Agents reason.

Organizations reason.

Multi-agent systems reason.

Future autonomous ecosystems will increasingly depend on reasoning to:

- make decisions
- evaluate evidence
- form conclusions
- generate plans
- assess risks
- allocate resources
- justify actions
- model future outcomes

Most governance approaches evaluate:

- outputs
- performance
- decisions
- results

However, before decisions emerge, reasoning has already occurred.

A conclusion may appear valid while the reasoning that produced it remains invalid.

This creates a critical governance challenge.

CRIS exists to govern that condition.

B. Core Principle

Conclusions are not valid merely because they appear correct.

Reasoning becomes valid only when inference, assumptions, evidence, logical transitions, and conclusion formation remain traceable, coherent, reconstructable, and governance-compatible throughout cognition.

C. Scope

This standard may apply to:

- human cognition
 - AI systems
 - autonomous agents
 - multi-agent systems
 - decision-support systems
 - governance systems
 - strategic planning systems
 - intelligence environments
 - reasoning engines
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- future autonomous cognition ecosystems

CRIS applies wherever conclusions emerge through reasoning.

D. Why This Standard Exists

Interpretation creates meaning.

Reasoning creates conclusions.

A cognition system may possess:

- valid signals
- valid context
- valid intent understanding
- valid meaning construction

and still produce invalid conclusions if reasoning becomes compromised.

Traditional systems often ask:

Was the conclusion correct?

CRIS asks a deeper question:

Was the reasoning valid?

As autonomous cognition becomes increasingly influential,
reasoning itself becomes a governable space.

CRIS exists because conclusions inherit the integrity of the reasoning that produced them.

E. Cognitive Reasoning Integrity Logic

Reasoning integrity exists only when the following remain materially preservable:

1. Inference Integrity

Inference transitions remain logically valid and traceable.

2. Assumption Integrity

Assumptions remain visible, identifiable, and governable.

3. Evidence Integrity

Evidence remains appropriately connected to reasoning.

4. Logical Consistency Integrity

Reasoning remains internally coherent and contradiction-aware.

5. Conclusion Integrity

Conclusions remain justified by reasoning conditions.

F. Operational Architecture Space

CRIS defines the operational architecture space for:

- reasoning governance
- inference governance
- assumption governance
- evidence reasoning
- logical consistency governance
- conclusion governance
- reasoning traceability
- reasoning validity
- cognition justification

This space exists because conclusions do not emerge directly from information.

They emerge through reasoning.

CRIS governs whether that reasoning remains valid.

G. Difference Between Meaning and Reasoning

Meaning and reasoning are related but structurally distinct.

Interpretation governs:

- meaning
- understanding
- contextual relevance
- intent recognition
- ambiguity management

Reasoning governs:

- inference
- logic
- justification
- conclusion formation
- evidence utilization
- assumption management

A cognition system may correctly understand meaning and still reason incorrectly.

CRIS governs the reasoning layer.

H. Runtime Position

CRIS operates within the Cognitive Reasoning Governance Layer of CLIA®.

It provides governance conditions for how cognition transforms meaning into conclusions before decisions, actions, recommendations, and plans are generated.

CRIS therefore sits directly downstream of CIIS.

I. Reasoning Drift Rule

Reasoning drift occurs when inference processes progressively diverge from governance-valid reasoning conditions while cognition continues assuming reasoning remains valid.

This may include:

- hidden assumptions
- unsupported inferences
- evidence detachment
- logical inconsistency
- reasoning shortcuts
- justification collapse
- conclusion inflation
- inference bias

A cognition system may therefore preserve operational usefulness while reasoning validity underneath progressively deteriorates.

CRIS exists to expose and govern that condition.

J. Validity Logic

A cognition environment is valid under CRIS when:

- reasoning remains traceable
- assumptions remain visible
- evidence remains connected
- logic remains coherent
- conclusions remain justified
- contradictions remain governable
- reasoning remains reconstructable

A cognition environment becomes invalid under CRIS when:

- assumptions become hidden
 - evidence becomes disconnected
 - inference becomes opaque
 - logic becomes inconsistent
 - conclusions become unjustified
 - contradictions become invisible
 - reasoning loses governance validity
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K. Relationship to Other OOF Standards

CRIS operates naturally with:

- Cognitive Integrity Standard (CIS)
- Cognitive Interpretation Integrity Standard (CIIS)
- Agent Cognition Integrity Standard (ACIS)
- Multi-Agent Cognition Integrity Standard (MCIS)
- Multi-Layer Truth Validation Framework (MTVF)
- Universal Canonical Language (UCL)
- Ethical Virtual Integrity Protocol (EVIP)
- INTEGROS® — Integrity Standard

CRIS does not replace these standards.

It governs the reasoning layer through which meaning becomes conclusions.

L. Foundational Principle

If reasoning cannot remain traceable, assumption-aware, evidence-connected, logically coherent, and governance-compatible, cognition may preserve meaning

while progressively losing conclusion validity.

Canonical Closing Statement

Cognitive Reasoning Integrity Standard (CRIS) defines the structural conditions under which reasoning processes, inference chains, logical transitions, conclusion formation, assumption management, evidence utilization, and cognitive justification remain traceable, coherent, reconstructable, governance-valid, and operationally reliable across human, agent, and multi-agent cognition environments.

Meaning alone does not govern cognition. Conclusions govern action.

Reasoning becomes governance-valid only when inference, assumptions, evidence, logic, and conclusions remain traceable, coherent, and operationally reliable throughout cognition.

Modules

[IIM→ Inference Integrity Module](#)

[AIM→ Assumption Integrity Module](#)

[EEIM→ Evidence Evaluation Integrity Module](#)

[LCIM→ Logical Consistency Integrity Module](#)

[CJIM→ Conclusion Justification Integrity Module](#)

Related Documents

[→ About the Cognitive Reasoning Integrity Standard \(CRIS\)](#)

[→ CLIA® Architecture Index](#)

[→ CLIA® Complete Standards & Modules Index](#)

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Canonical Source

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